[Metric]
A-A-2903
April 08, 1996

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
BRUSH, STENCIL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies and will replace Federal Specification H-B-621 which is canceled.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers brushes used for spreading stencil ink or paint through stencils.

2. Classification:

Type: I. Long Handle
II. Short Handle
III. Fountain Handle

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Hog Bristle. The bristle shall be stiff, resilient hog bristle and shall be cleaned and sterilized. It shall have no perceptible change in stiffness or evidence of artificial color when tested as specified in paragraph 5.3.1.

3.2 Type I & II handles shall be composed of either wood or synthetic material. The wood handles shall be varnished or lacquered, a close and straight grained hardwood that is thoroughly and uniformly dried in accordance with normal commercial practice. The synthetic material shall be a polypropylene foam plastic of any color with a minimum density of 0.5 g/ml. The brush head shall be trimmed solid to a square top and be composed of hog bristle.

3.3 The ferrule shall be nickel plated, round seamless steel and shall be pinned to the handle by at least 3 nails or similar fasteners, or crimped in accordance with normal commercial practice. The bottom edge of the ferrule shall be a crimped or rolled edge to retain the bristle setting.

3.4 Type III brushes shall be comprised of a metal handle containing an ink reservoir, a brush tip and an ink feed mechanism to control the ink flow from the reservoir to the brush tip. The handle shall be a one-piece metal shell. The reservoir formed by the shell shall hold not less than 59 ml (2 fl. oz.) of ink. Means shall be provided to facilitate refilling of the reservoir.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarification's, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278

FSC 7520

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3.5 The ink feed mechanism housing shall be threaded at one end to receive the brush tip and at the other end to attach the ink reservoir. The mechanism shall be designed to feed ink to the brush tip and may be one of the following:

(A). A spring loaded valve which is depressed to permit the flow, and released to stop.
(B). A valve which is opened and closed by rotating the tip.

The ink feed mechanism shall be removable for cleaning and replacement. The ink feed outlet shall be located within the housing and shall be designed to feed ink directly to the brush tip.

3.6 Dimensions.

Table 1.
Minimum Physical Requirements

Characteristic	Type I.	Type II.	Type III.
Length, Overall:	22.8 cm (9 in)	11.747 cm (4.625 in)	17.8 cm (7 in)
Ferrule.			
Inside Diameter at:			
Bristle	2.0 cm (0.78 in)	2.857 cm (1 .125 in)	3.5 cm (1.375 in)
Depth	3.2 cm (1.125 in)	2.540 cm (1 in)	
Thickness	0.46 mm (0.018 in)	.114 cm (.045 inch)	
Bristle.			
Inside Length of:			
Ferrule	1.0 cm (0.375 in)	1.27 cm (.5 in)	
Outside Length of:			
Ferrule	2.4 cm (0.937 in)	3.175 cm (1.25 in)	3.8 cm (1.5 in)
Weight	10.5 g (0.37 oz)	1.803 g (0.71 oz)	28.3g (1.000 oz)

3.7 Brush Tip & Cover. The brush tip unit shall be threaded to fit into the ink feed housing mechanism. When specified in the ordering data, a brush-tip cover of light weight metal, plastic or nylon shall be furnished. The cover shall fit over the brush-tip ferrule by means of a friction fit or a threaded connection.

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3.8 Sterilization. Hog bristle shall be sterilized at some point in the suppliers manufacturing process, after thorough washing and rinsing in accordance with either by boiling water, dry heat, or autoclaving procedure, as follows:

A. In the boiling water procedure, the hog bristle shall be soaked in boiling water at 100° C (212° F) for not less than 30 minutes.
B. In the dry heat procedure, the hog bristle shall be placed in a chamber and maintained for a minimum of 3 hours at a temperature of not less than 140° C (284° F).
C. In the autoclaving method, the hog bristle shall be placed in a pressure chamber for a minimum of 15 minutes at not less than a pressure of 2.09 kg (f) cm2 (15 psi), and at a temperature not less than 140° C (248° F) for a minimum of 20 minutes.

3.9 Set. The butt ends of all bristles shall be set by vulcanizing in hard rubber, setting in epoxy resin, or other suitable compound in accordance with normal commercial practice. The bristles shall not separate from the ferrule.

3.10 Workmanship. The brush shall be free from any defects and imperfections which may adversely affect appearance, serviceability, and durability.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 General Quality. The products provided shall conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provision of the contract.

5.2 Examination & Sampling.

5.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibits control over their processes (e.g. Statistical process Controls). These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in the applicable technical document or herein. For those product characteristics which are controlled by such a method, requirements for end item inspection or test may be considered to have been met.

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5.2.2 End item inspection / testing may be used by the offeror, or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in-process quality controls provided that the manufacturer supplies certifies item is in conformance. While in-process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing they may be implemented when performing visual and dimensional inspections.

5.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / shall be required. The sample unit shall be one brush. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society of Quality Control (ASQC) ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 1993, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.2.4 For visual and dimensional inspections the level shall be S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. For performance testing the level shall be S-2 with a AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (test and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

5.3 Performance Testing.

5.3.1 Soak Test.

Soak the bristle in boiling water at 100° C (212° F) for one hour. Remove the bristle from the water and place it face up in a holding device so that it is held firmly in a manner and position similar to a finished brush. A finished brush shall be attached in a face up position along side the bristle. The bristle in the holding device and brush shall be brushed with the palm of the hand for comparison.

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Source of Documents: The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this commercial item description.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2, Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

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7.2 Ordering Information: Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order.

A. Type.
B. Which brush tip cover (metal, nylon or plastic) is required.

7.3 National Stock Number Listing (NSNs. The following is a list of NSNs assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID.

Brush, Stencil

7520-00-223-8000
7520-00-248-9285
7520-00-223-7989

Tip, Fountain Type

7520-00-369-4714

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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